body-based interactions with the material world and is of two kinds: primary, non-verbal sensory awareness in which specific characteristics are not explicitly recognised for what they are (***nirvikalpaka-pratyaksha***) and awareness saturated by concepts and language (***savikalpaka-pratyaksha***) which identifies the given more specifically); inference (***anumana***) which is dependent upon information supplied by sensory perception; language (*shabda*), which is the testimony of experts.

They emphasise right understanding of the structures and operations of the cosmos as a path to release from rebirth. Given that the soul, although an individual principle of continuity, is not essentially conscious (although it becomes the substrate of cognitive episodes, feelings and acts of will) it is not something to be clung to. The state of release is one of non-consciousness. There is no pure happiness, because happiness is always pervaded by fear of its loss.

Further reading: G. Bhattacharya 1989; Ganeri 2001a; Ganeri 2001b; Matilal 1986, 1998 and 2002b; Potter 1977

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Padartha (category of entities): according to ***Vaisheshika***, these are the types of objectively real basic features that organise, structure and give identity to individual objects in the cosmos. (*Padartha* may also refer to a particular object belonging to a type of entities.) The categories are ***dravya*** (substantial continuants), ***guna*** (qualities or particular properties), ***karma*** (motions), ***samanya*** (generic properties), ***samavaya*** (inherence or internal relation), ***vishesha*** (individualising mark of atoms and souls) and ***abhava*** (absences). Types of features belonging to the